THE BORROWED BICYCLE

Written by

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Self-written sample screenplay for Panelwise.
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FADE IN:

EXT. DUSTY YARD - DAY

A small yard behind a brick house. Chickens peck at the ground. Against the fence leans a shining BLUE BICYCLE with a silver bell.

NALEDI (12), dungarees, scraped knees, stares at it. Her little brother TSHEPO (8), shorts down past his knees, stands beside her.

NALEDI
It's Mr. Kekana's. He said nobody touches it.

TSHEPO
He's at church until twelve.

NALEDI
That's not the point.

Tshepo rings the bell. Ting-ting. They both freeze and look at the house.

Nothing happens.

NALEDI
One ride. Around the block. Then straight back.

EXT. GRAVEL ROAD - MOMENTS LATER

Naledi pedals standing up. Tshepo sits on the carrier behind her, arms around her waist, screaming with joy. Dust flies up from the wheels.

TSHEPO
Faster! Faster!

They fly past a SPAZA SHOP. The SHOPKEEPER (60s) looks up from his newspaper.

SHOPKEEPER
Is that Kekana's bicycle?

NALEDI
(over her shoulder)
No!

EXT. HILL ROAD - DAY

The road tips downhill. The bicycle picks up speed. Naledi squeezes the brakes. Nothing.

NALEDI
The brakes don't work!

TSHEPO
Why would he have a bicycle with no brakes?

NALEDI
Maybe that's why nobody touches it!

At the bottom of the hill, a big muddy PUDDLE.

EXT. BOTTOM OF THE HILL - CONTINUOUS

SPLASH. The bicycle hits the puddle and stops dead. Naledi and Tshepo tumble sideways into the mud.

They sit up, brown from head to toe. The bicycle lies on its side, its front wheel still spinning.

Tshepo starts to laugh. Naledi tries not to, and fails.

EXT. DUSTY YARD - LATER

Naledi scrubs the bicycle with a bucket and a rag. Tshepo polishes the bell with the hem of his shirt.

The bicycle shines again. The two children, however, are still covered in mud.

The back door opens. MR. KEKANA (70s), in a church suit and a hat with a feather, steps out. He looks at the bicycle. He looks at the children.

MR. KEKANA
You went down the hill.

NALEDI
How did you know?

MR. KEKANA
Because that's where I went, fifty years ago, the day I got it. The brakes have never worked since.

He takes off his hat and hangs it on the handlebars.

MR. KEKANA
Next Sunday, I'll show you how to fix them. Then you can borrow it properly.

TSHEPO
Can we ride it now?

MR. KEKANA
(pointing at a tap)
Now you wash.

FADE OUT.